

The Australian BTR Success Summit
19-20th February 2026



“Defining Success in Australia’s Operational Real Estate”

Sydney

Thursday 19th February– Friday 20th February

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Confirmed Speakers

1. **Michael Camerlengo**, Deputy Chief Investment Officer and Executive Leader Clients and Capital, **Housing Australia**
2. **Luke Mackintosh**, Partner, Project & Infrastructure Advisory, **BDO**
3. **Veno Panicker**, Partner Construction & Infrastructure, **Hamilton Locke**
4. **Anouk Darling**, CEO, **Scape Australia**
5. **Ben Burston**, Chief Economist, **Knight Frank**
6. **Nicola Lemon**, Director - Enterprise (National Social and Affordable Housing Lead), **KPMG**
7. **Paul Zahara**, Director, **Austar Finance**
8. **Emile McPhee**, Partner Finance & Community Housing, **Hamilton Locke**
9. **Puian Mollaian**, Co-Founder, Investment Director, **aptResidential**
10. **Marcus Greening**, Associate | Residential Design Lead, **i2C Architects**
11. **James Eadie**, Senior Sales Manager, **REA Group**
12. **Lizzie Wheeler**, Executive General Manager, **Essence Communities**
13. **Julian Anderson**, Director, **Bates Smart**
14. **Ashley Reed**, CFO, **MODEL**
15. **Tristan Quinn**, Principal, **Franklin St.**
16. **Mitchell Tayt**, General Manager Build to Rent, **Goldfields Group**
17. **Ben Martin-Henry**, Head of Private Assets Research, **MSCI**
18. **Matt Woodland**, Managing Director, **Greystar Australia**
19. **Edward Mcauliffe**, Director of Residential Development & BTR Operations, **Salta Properties Pty**
20. **Paul Savitz**, Director Living Sectors Capital Markets, **Cushman & Wakefield**
21. **Trina Jones**, NSW rental Commissioner, **NSW Government**
22. **Blake Sly**, Senior Director, **Australian Taxation Office**

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DAY ONE – Thursday, 19th February 2026

8:00 Registration

8:45 Welcome to Country

9:00 Introduction and Overview

INVESTMENT & PERFORMANCE BENCHMARKING

9:10 Fireside Chat: Recipe for Access Unlocking Capability to Expand Housing Capacity

- Defining the key ingredients for successful Build-to-Rent community projects through partnerships and long-term planning
- De-risking projects to attract long-term institutional capital required for delivering development rapidly without sacrificing quality
- Outlining what BTR housing investment means more broadly than stronger lease security and stability that Australian families need.

Michael Camerlengo, Deputy Chief Investment Officer and Executive Leader Clients and Capital, **Housing Australia**, **Puian Mollaian**, Co-Founder, Investment Director, **aptResidential**

9:50 Keynote: Australia's First Wave of Build-to Rent Performance Unpacked

- Insights into the real-world impact of interest rates, cap rates, and negative leverage on initial project returns.
- Assessing the true cost of delivery, from labour and materials to the hidden costs of planning delays.
- Benchmarking actual asset performance: Are lease-up velocity and stabilised yields meeting pro-forma expectations?

Matt Woodland, Managing Director, **Greystar Australia**

10:30 Morning tea & coffee

POLICY, PLANNING, AND TAXATION

11:00 Legislative Differences: A Build-To-Rent Legislative Comparison

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- A granular, state-by-state analysis of planning pathways and their direct impact on project feasibility.
- Which states are getting it right? Identifying the specific policies that are successfully accelerating development.
- What are the next critical policy reforms needed to unlock institutional investment at a national scale?
- Who will build? Bringing together skilled trades through federal and state programs.

Luke Mackintosh, Partner, Project & Infrastructure Advisory, **BDO**, **Veno Panicker**, Partner Construction & Infrastructure, **Hamilton Locke**

11:45 Designing Investments for Community and Competitive Advantage

- Suburbs Beyond the CBD with the highest demand for quality rental products. Efficiency of design and value of money.
- What foreign capital wants: Understanding the specific performance and ESG metrics that global investors are underwriting.
- Designing for the entire lifecycle: How can one asset effectively appeal to demographics from young professionals to downsizers?

Tristan Quinn, Principal, **Franklin St.**

12:15 Keynote: Tax Structures for Operational Real Estate

- A practical guide to accessing the 4% accelerated capital works deduction and the 15% concessional MIT withholding tax rate to support project feasibility.
- De-risking Your Project & Understanding the Commissioner's Discretion: the practical steps for rectification to safeguard your project's eligibility in the face of unforeseen challenges.
- An overview of the affordable tenancy requirements, lodgement processes, and the critical clawback provisions to ensure your project remains compliant.

Blake Sly, Senior Director, **Australian Taxation Office**

12:45 Networking Lunch

PRODUCT STRATEGY AND RESIDENT DEMAND

1:45 Build-to-Rent Delivering Security, Quality, and Community

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- Analysing case studies of projects delivering quality housing for middle-income Australia in key urban corridors over multi-decade lifespans.
- Demonstrating the economic benefits of providing secure, high-quality housing as a requirement of the development.
- How can developers deliver affordability while still meeting institutional return hurdles?

Edward Mcauliffe, Director of Residential Development & BTR Operations, **Salta Properties Pty Ltd**

2:15 The Depth on Leasehold Communities: Analysis of the Diverse Renter Market

- Which markets are seeing the most demand for rental products? Which products are most desirable in these markets? Pinpointing which markets are seeing the highest demand for different BTR products.
- Understanding the performance and ESG metrics that foreign capital is looking for in a BTR product.
- Developing housing that appeals to the entire renter lifecycle, from first-timers to downsizers.

Anouk Darling, CEO, **Scape Australia**, **Paul Savitz**, Director Living Sectors Capital Markets, **Cushman & Wakefield**

2:55 Afternoon tea

THE GLOBAL & DOMESTIC CAPITAL LANDSCAPE

3:20 Forecasting BTR Demand and the Direct Impact of Migration on Housing

- Analysing how current and future immigration trends are set to directly impact housing demand.
- Understanding the housing habits and preferences of new Australians to inform product design.
- A practical guide on how to factor economic changes into financial models to accurately underwrite future rent growth.

Ben Burston, Chief Economist, **Knight Frank**, **Benjamin Martin-Henry**, Head of Private Assets Research, **MSCI**

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4:05 Panel: Applying Global Urban Planning Lessons to Australian BTR

- Examining how mature BTR markets like the UK and US have integrated BTR into urban planning.
- Key lessons learned from international markets on density, placemaking, and community integration.
- Applying global best practices to the Australian planning and development context.

Marcus Greening, Residential Design Lead, **i2C Architects**, **Julian Anderson**, Director, **Bates Smart**, **Mitchell Tayt**, General Manager Build to Rent, **Goldfields Group**

4:50 Acknowledgements and Closing Statements

5:00 Networking drinks

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DAY TWO - Friday, 20th February 2026

8:30 Registration

9:05 Opening Address and Acknowledgements

MASTERING THE DEVELOPMENT AND DELIVERY PIPELINE

9:10 Keynote: The Sustainable Vision for BTR and the Future of the Tenant Experience

- A practical outline of what a best-practice BTR model looks like from the regulator's perspective, from fairer lease terms to improved building quality and maintenance standards.
- Exploring management models, particularly co-management partnerships with community housing providers, to ensure BTR developments provide well-maintained homes for a diverse mix of residents, including low-income renters and secure long-term leaseholders.

Trina Jones, NSW rental Commissioner, **NSW Government**

9:40 Getting Ahead When Housing and Land Supply is in Crisis

- Can state-level intervention break the hold of local councils to unlock land supply?
- Reforming infrastructure contributions: Debating new models to lower the prohibitive upfront cost of delivery for developers
- Articulating the economic case for BTR to governments as a key driver of housing supply

Paul Nicolau, Executive Director, **Business Sydney**

10:30 Morning tea & coffee

11:00 Blending Social and Specialist Housing for Impact and Profit

- A practical guide to integrating social housing into a BTR project.
- How mixed-tenure models can de-risk planning approvals and unlock government incentives.
- Demonstrating how to deliver both strong financial returns and measurable social impact.

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Nicola Lemon, Director - Enterprise (National Social and Affordable Housing Lead), **KPMG**, **Emile McPhee**, Partner Finance & Community Housing, **Hamilton Locke**

11:45 The Ownership Rebrand and the appeal of BTR Lease agreements for the Ideal Resident

- Strategies for creating a powerful brand identity that attracts and secures the ideal resident.
- Leveraging technology and data to optimise the leasing process and reduce vacancy rates.

James Eadie, Senior Sales Manager, **REA Group**

12:15 Unlocking Debt & Leverage for BTR Projects

- A clear discussion on the key factors dictating funding availability, from developer track record to project pre-sales.
- A deep dive into underwriting, learn how are rising insurance, construction, and operational costs impacting lender models and LVRs?
- Bank vs. Non-Bank: Understanding the differences in risk appetite, cost of capital, and structuring flexibility.

Ashley Reed, CFO, **Model**

1:00 Lunch

OPERATIONS, CAPITAL, AND ASSET MANAGEMENT

1:50 Op Cos In-House & Third-Party Management

- Defining the essential capabilities in operating large scale development from resident experience and tech integration to financial reporting and how to find the right management team.
- At what point does an in-house operating platform become more effective and financially viable than a third-party model?
- A practical guide to structuring management agreements to ensure alignment and performance.

Lizzie Wheeler, Executive General Manager, **Essence Communities**

2:30 Leveraging Technology and Prefab for Productivity in Build-To-Rent Delivery

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- this session unpacks the building technology and methodologies that are non-negotiable for the next wave of BTR.
- Assessing the real-world ROI of modular construction in the BTR context and digital platforms that provide certainty for management from groundbreaking to operations.
- How to integrate smart housing solutions (access, energy, security) during the build phase to reduce long-term operational costs, enhance the resident experience, and create a more valuable, future-proofed asset.

3:00 Build to Rent vs Build to Sell: Which works and for who

- The Capital Question: Comparing the long-term, stable income of BTR against the upfront returns and capital gains of BTS.
- The Investor Lens: Why negative gearing and tax benefits work for individuals but create fundamental hurdles for institutional capital.
- The Market Cycle: Which economic conditions, locations, and interest rate environments favour one model over the other?

Paul Zahara, Director, **Austar Finance**

3:30 Summit Closing Remarks and Key Takeaways